

The Geo G1 is a dualband flip-phone that features two LCD displays and an integrated digital camera—a flash and 4X digital zoom included. Weighing just about 90 gm, it's flat and wide, and fits in your pocket easily. The external antenna may deter you from carrying it in your jeans though.

The chrome bordered external LCD is flanked by two bars that integrate thin LED that light up when you close the phone flap.

The external LCD measures 21 x 14 mm and displays battery status, signal strength, alarm and profile indicators, as well as incoming calls or messages. It plays assistant when taking self-portraits using the camera button located on the side of the phone. Supporting 260K colours, the main LCD TFT screen comes alive when you open the phone. It stores 300 contacts, complete with different numbers for home, cellular, and office along with data such as e-mail and anniversary.

You can assign contacts to four preset, or three customisable groups and set different ringtones for a specific contact, or a whole group.

The self-timer can be set from 5 to 15 seconds, while the camera can be set to auto, sunny, cloudy, fluorescent or tungsten mode. Choose from resolutions that range from 64 x 96, 160 x 120 and 640 x 480 for the image size. The multi-shot feature can be used to capture multiple shots at one go. You can set it to snap 3 to 9 frames at a time. You can also capture video clips limited to a 10-second duration. These can have a resolution of 64 x 96, 120x 160 or 176 x 144. You cannot record audio though.

Messaging features include predictive text input, 10 inbuilt templates and MMS. You can also schedule the phone to switch on or off automatically. The Geo

G1 also includes two games and 'Avatar', an application that offers you a menu of different face types, eyes, hair, etc, to create digital personas. These can then be associated to your contacts, set as backgrounds for the main screen or sent as MMS.

On the flip side, the phone finds it difficult to detect the network in areas where the signal strength is weak, and hence goes into search mode, thus affecting battery life. SMS junkies may not like the keypad as its keys lack depth—you need to press them with the tip of your thumb. The Geo G1 is spring-loaded and hence, is not much of a hassle to use single-handedly.

The captured images and video clips are fairly decent. The phone connects to a PC via the serial port using the bundled cable. The GEOsync software provided lets you synchronise phone contacts, messages, schedule, memo, To do, images and melodies stored on the phone. You can also synchronise its contacts and schedules with Microsoft Outlook.

The bundled lithium-ion battery that's thicker (and heavier) by usual standards, lasts for about double the time. An external desktop charger, a travel charger and a manual that does not provide any information regarding PC connectivity are also bundled.

The Geo G1 is a great phone if looks matter the most. However, considering its network detection problems, poor application support, lack of support for JAVA applications, combined with the high price tag, it's not worth buying.



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